

DAL by 1.3

54%



ATL win 46% · pick'em (0) · DAL win 54%

Shaded area each side of pick'em = each team's win chance; dark tick = our call.

Projected score DAL 83 — ATL 84 · Total 183

Some inputs served from the most-recent available build (winprob) — see companion file for detail.

Read

DAL is the narrow side of a near coin-flip (54% to win). The catch: ATL is down a rotation piece — I. Nivar (impact +0.7) is OUT and already removed from the projection below.

- DAL is the narrow side of a near coin-flip here (54% to win); we project DAL 83, ATL 84.
- The model's on-court player ratings tilt to ATL — its top three rate +6.5 combined vs +3.5 on the other side (impact = points added vs an average player; see the box).
- Availability: ATL without T. Paopao, I. Nivar (2 OUT) — OUT players are excluded from the box; the minutes of any projected among them are redistributed into the rotation below.
- How sure: 4 games in 5 the DAL margin lands between -16 and +17 (+ = DAL ahead) — single games swing a lot, and even so DAL loses outright about 46% of the time.

Injuries & availability — out of the projected box

| TEAM | PLAYER         | STATUS / CAUSE   | GAMES MISSED | EXP. RETURN |
|------|----------------|------------------|--------------|-------------|
| ATL  | Te-Hina Paopao | Leg              | 2            | Aug 10      |
| ATL  | Indya Nivar    | Coach's decision | 3            | Jul 29      |

Cause read from the injury feed's report; games missed = the team's games played since the player last appeared; expected return as reported ('TBD' = no date given).

Players to watch

Each side's top two projected scorers — biggest game-changer first (impact = points added vs an average player); the % is the team's scoring each carries.

- ATL A. Gray 17 pts (20% of ATL's scoring) / 3 reb / 2 ast in 31 min · +1.3 impact · R. Howard 14 pts (17% of ATL's scoring) / 4 reb / 3 ast in 32 min · -0.5 impact
- DAL P. Bueckers 19 pts (23% of DAL's scoring) / 4 reb / 6 ast in 33 min · +1.2 impact · J. Shepard 13 pts (16% of DAL's scoring) / 12 reb / 5 ast in 33 min · +0.2 impact

Projected box

Big # = jersey · bold above the line = projected starters (top-5 minutes) · IMPACT = points added vs an average player per 100 possessions (— = not yet rated).  
Source: per-slate minutes + player-rate projections, availability-adjusted (minutes → 200, points scaled to the simulation score).

ATL

| #  | PLAYER    | IMPACT | MIN  | PTS  | REB | AST | 3PM |
|----|-----------|--------|------|------|-----|-----|-----|
| 3  | J. Canada | +3.4   | 32.5 | 11.7 | 3.5 | 7.2 | 1.0 |
| 10 | R. Howard | -0.5   | 32.3 | 13.9 | 3.6 | 3.3 | 2.6 |
| 15 | A. Gray   | +1.3   | 31.3 | 16.7 | 2.9 | 2.5 | 1.6 |

| #  | PLAYER                                        | IMPACT | MIN   | PTS  | REB | AST | 3PM |
|----|-----------------------------------------------|--------|-------|------|-----|-----|-----|
| 00 | N. Hillmon                                    | +1.8   | 28.8  | 7.2  | 4.2 | 1.2 | 1.1 |
| 5  | A. Reese                                      | -0.2   | 27.3  | 13.9 | 9.3 | 1.8 | 0.3 |
| 42 | B. Jones<br>F · 6'3" · thin sample            | —      | 14.3  | 6.5  | 4.9 | 1.6 | 0.4 |
| 20 | I. Borlase                                    | -0.1   | 13.6  | 5.1  | 1.5 | 1.1 | 0.7 |
| 11 | M. Okot                                       | -1.4   | 9.9   | 5.8  | 3.0 | 0.4 | 0.2 |
| 23 | S. Kone                                       | +1.2   | 6.6   | 2.6  | 1.2 | 0.4 | 0.3 |
| 33 | S. Walker-Kimbrough<br>G · 5'9" · thin sample | +1.0   | 2.0   | 0.4  | 0.2 | 0.2 | 0.1 |
| 32 | A. Nye<br>G · 6'0" · thin sample              | -0.1   | 1.4   | 0.4  | 0.1 | 0.2 | 0.1 |
|    | Team                                          |        | 200.0 | 84.2 |     |     |     |

## DAL

| #  | PLAYER                              | IMPACT | MIN   | PTS  | REB  | AST | 3PM |
|----|-------------------------------------|--------|-------|------|------|-----|-----|
| 32 | J. Shepard                          | +0.2   | 33.1  | 13.0 | 11.5 | 4.8 | 0.2 |
| 5  | P. Bueckers                         | +1.2   | 32.6  | 19.2 | 4.2  | 5.5 | 1.5 |
| 35 | A. Fudd                             | +1.2   | 31.2  | 11.8 | 2.1  | 2.4 | 1.9 |
| 24 | A. Ogunbowale                       | -1.0   | 28.9  | 12.6 | 2.8  | 2.7 | 1.6 |
| 20 | M. Siegrist                         | +0.5   | 13.9  | 5.3  | 2.3  | 0.8 | 0.7 |
| 34 | A. Kuier                            | +0.1   | 12.4  | 3.9  | 2.6  | 0.7 | 0.4 |
| 28 | L. Yueru                            | +0.3   | 9.5   | 3.3  | 3.0  | 0.5 | 0.4 |
| 8  | A. Smith                            | +1.0   | 9.3   | 3.1  | 2.0  | 0.4 | 0.4 |
| 1  | O. Sims                             | -0.6   | 8.7   | 3.3  | 0.7  | 1.3 | 0.4 |
| 7  | A. Clark                            | -1.9   | 7.9   | 1.7  | 1.0  | 0.6 | 0.3 |
| 10 | A. James                            | +0.2   | 6.9   | 3.2  | 1.2  | 0.8 | 0.3 |
| 6  | C. Verona<br>G · 5'7" · thin sample | -0.0   | 5.6   | 2.2  | 0.8  | 0.7 | 0.2 |
|    | Team                                |        | 200.0 | 82.6 |      |     |     |

## A deeper look

### What tonight means

A win tonight puts **ATL**'s playoff chances at **100%** — a loss drops them to **99%**.

Across both teams that makes this the **12th-biggest playoff-swing game** of this week's 19 remaining games.

ATL

if they win

100%

if they lose

99%

Playoff swing: 1 points · Typical seed: about 4th with a win, 5th with a loss.

DAL

if they win

100%

if they lose

100%

Playoff swing: 0 points · Typical seed: about 3rd with a win, 4th with a loss.

Source: the rest of the season replayed 10,000 times, split by tonight's result (may differ from the headline odds by a fraction of a point — same simulation, different run counts).

### Season odds — playoffs & title

ATL

PLAYOFFS

99%

TITLE

22.8%

Source: live 1M-run season simulation (the board's odds core).

Starting-five skill profiles

|                         |                        |     |                       |                        |    |
|-------------------------|------------------------|-----|-----------------------|------------------------|----|
| <b>3 J. Canada</b>      |                        |     | <b>10 R. Howard</b>   |                        |    |
| Offense                 | <div><div></div></div> | 56  | Offense               | <div><div></div></div> | 84 |
| Defense                 | <div><div></div></div> | 96  | Defense               | <div><div></div></div> | 72 |
| Playmaking              | <div><div></div></div> | 96  | Playmaking            | <div><div></div></div> | 93 |
| Rebounding              | <div><div></div></div> | 26  | Rebounding            | <div><div></div></div> | 33 |
| X-factor                | <div><div></div></div> | 10  | X-factor              | <div><div></div></div> | 42 |
| <b>15 A. Gray</b>       |                        |     | <b>00 N. Hillmon</b>  |                        |    |
| Offense                 | <div><div></div></div> | 93  | Offense               | <div><div></div></div> | 48 |
| Defense                 | <div><div></div></div> | 52  | Defense               | <div><div></div></div> | 77 |
| Playmaking              | <div><div></div></div> | 80  | Playmaking            | <div><div></div></div> | 66 |
| Rebounding              | <div><div></div></div> | 50  | Rebounding            | <div><div></div></div> | 87 |
| X-factor                | <div><div></div></div> | 97  | X-factor              | <div><div></div></div> | 67 |
| <b>5 A. Reese</b>       |                        |     | <b>32 J. Shepard</b>  |                        |    |
| Offense                 | <div><div></div></div> | 80  | Offense               | <div><div></div></div> | 73 |
| Defense                 | <div><div></div></div> | 55  | Defense               | <div><div></div></div> | 60 |
| Playmaking              | <div><div></div></div> | 52  | Playmaking            | <div><div></div></div> | 73 |
| Rebounding              | <div><div></div></div> | 100 | Rebounding            | <div><div></div></div> | 99 |
| X-factor                | <div><div></div></div> | 23  | X-factor              | <div><div></div></div> | 37 |
| <b>5 P. Bueckers</b>    |                        |     | <b>35 A. Fudd</b>     |                        |    |
| Offense                 | <div><div></div></div> | 95  | No prior-season       |                        |    |
| Defense                 | <div><div></div></div> | 62  | skill data yet        |                        |    |
| Playmaking              | <div><div></div></div> | 97  | (first WNBA           |                        |    |
| Rebounding              | <div><div></div></div> | 25  | season)               |                        |    |
| X-factor                | <div><div></div></div> | 78  |                       |                        |    |
| <b>24 A. Ogunbowale</b> |                        |     | <b>20 M. Siegrist</b> |                        |    |
| Offense                 | <div><div></div></div> | 72  | Offense               | <div><div></div></div> | 75 |
| Defense                 | <div><div></div></div> | 74  | Defense               | <div><div></div></div> | 48 |
| Playmaking              | <div><div></div></div> | 89  | Playmaking            | <div><div></div></div> | 34 |
| Rebounding              | <div><div></div></div> | 3   | Rebounding            | <div><div></div></div> | 49 |
| X-factor                | <div><div></div></div> | 33  | X-factor              | <div><div></div></div> | 60 |

Source: league-percentile bars from each player's most recent full-season profile (the 2025 season); first-year players have none yet. Estimated from public play-by-play.

Appendix — how the numbers are made

- Scores, totals & the margin distribution = a 1M-run Monte-Carlo simulation; spread = regression + home recalibration; the margin curve & ranges are calibrated intervals (~89% observed coverage at the 90% target); playoff leverage = the season replayed 10,000 times, split by tonight's result.
- Player values = per-minute rates (last-10-games form → season → positional average) × projected minutes, team points scaled to the simulation total. Minutes = per-slate projection + injury redistribution under per-player caps — OUT players removed and their minutes reallocated (box sums to 200; a "provisional" team has rotation players missing from tonight's model, so its box shows only the modeled minutes and is not inflated).
- Some player-level estimates lean on the limited public play-by-play for this league; richer tracking data would sharpen them.

**THE SEASON SO FAR (through 998 games):** Our spread calls miss by an average of 10.8 points · when we make a team a 60%+ favorite, they win 68% of the time · player minutes within +/-6.0, points within +/-3.9 (player lines: reconstructed day-before for all 143 games; live tracking began Jul 8.)  
**Recent monthly accuracy (average miss, lower is better):** May '25 9.9 · Jun '25 10.7 · Jul '25 11.7 · Aug '25 10.0 · Sep '25 10.3 · May '26 11.1 · Jun '26 10.6 · Jul '26 12.2 points.  
*all-games: spread +/-10.8 · minutes +/-6.0 · points +/-3.8*

Generated 2026-07-29T04:02:57Z · report of record. Built by The Hardwood from existing production models — no new models and no hand-entered numbers. Full methodology and sources are in this game's companion notes.